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POLICY AT A GLANCE

Disease Programmes in India: Countering Dual Burden

Health Sector in India

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The '**Policy-at-a-Glance**' provides users with curated information for first-level analysis and inter-state comparisons of policy. The document brings together all topic-relevant national and state-level acts, policies, and schemes in one place. Further, it identifies for a reader what policy features are covered in which document in a simple table.

The first section of this document sets out some '*Context and Background*' on the topic; the subsequent sections explain the '*Policy Features*' that have been compared; and the last section is the '*Table of Insights*' that marks out what '*Policy Feature*' has been covered (and on which page) in each of the topic-relevant documents.

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1. Context

The government of India has taken several initiatives for Disease prevention and has made substantial progress in the prevention, control, and elimination of diseases over the years. For instance, India has made significant progress in reducing HIV infections by more than 50% in the past two decades; has developed a Nationwide Strategic Plan to prevent the spread of Tuberculosis and has made remarkable progress towards controlling the TB situation in India.

Under National Health Mission various programmes are launched for the containment of communicable and non-communicable diseases. Some of the flagship programmes include National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme (NTEP), the National Programme for Prevention and Control of Cancer, Diabetes, Cardiovascular Diseases and Stroke (NPCDCS), the Integrated Disease surveillance Programme (IDSP), etc.

However, despite so many programmes and policies towards containment, control, monitoring, and evaluation of diseases; India still faces a dual burden of existing communicable diseases and increasing non-communicable diseases.

The National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC) is the apex body for disease control and public health in India, and was formed for coordinating disease surveillance, outbreak investigations, and implementing control measures.

This document collates information on different policy approaches to contain communicable and non-communicable diseases in India. As India's disease burden continues to evolve, state governments play a pivotal role in shaping policies. And understanding the diverse approaches taken by different states is essential in deploying successful approaches in other states and thereby accelerating the elimination of diseases.

2. Policy Features

Various policies have been implemented focusing on disease prevention and control and have been executed in various states/UTs, thereby yielding divergent levels of activities covered across different regions of India. This section identifies a common set of policy features that the document referred to in section 3 (table of insights) cover. The features are classified under the following three broad aspects of policy: 1) Prevention and Treatment, 2) Disease Surveillance, and 3) Awareness

1. Prevention and Treatment

- a. **State Specific Action Plan for containment of AMR:** Delhi, Madhya Pradesh, and Kerala have state-specific AMR containment plans apart from the National Action Plan on Antimicrobial Resistance. Kerala was the first State to develop its own specific State action plan which was followed by Madhya Pradesh. The MP-SAPCAR also involves multiple stakeholders from various departments, such as health, medical education, animal husbandry, fishery, farmer welfare, agriculture development, labour, public work and environment. Delhi SAPCAR was launched in January 2020 by the Government of Delhi, with the support of the World Health Organization (WHO) and other partners.
- b. **Financial Aid for Cancer:** Eleven states provide financial assistance to cancer patients within state health insurance plans or through other schemes. There are various schemes and programmes offered by the central and state governments in India to provide financial aid for cancer patients. For example, the Mukhya Mantri Sahayat Yojana in Himachal Pradesh, covers the cost of radiotherapy and chemotherapy for cancer patients up to Rs 5 lakhs. The scheme also provides a monthly pension of Rs 3,000 to the eligible beneficiaries. (Mukhya Mantri Sahayat Yojana. n.d.)

2. Disease Surveillance

- c. **Integrated Disease Surveillance Project:** The Integrated Disease Surveillance Project (IDSP) is a national programme that aims to monitor and respond to outbreaks of epidemic-prone diseases in India. The programme covers all the states and union territories of India, and has established surveillance units at the central, state, and district levels. Animal Disease Surveillance is a scheme implemented by the Department of Animal Husbandry and Animal Welfare of Puducherry. It aims to collect, analyses and interpret data on the prevalence and patterns of various diseases of livestock and poultry in the state. In an exemplary effort, the State of Haryana Monitoring and Evaluation division conducts interventional study on Anaemia among school-going children of Haryana. (State Health Systems Resource Centre, Haryana. n.d).

3. Awareness

- d. **Awareness Programmes for Communicable Diseases:** Various information education and communication initiatives have been undertaken to address awareness issues of major communicable diseases like AIDS, Tuberculosis, and other diseases. 21 states have established AIDS control society to conduct awareness drives towards the disease. AIDS control society initially focused on awareness generation and moved on to targeted intervention. To guarantee quality health services for people living with HIV, Jharkhand State AIDS control Society (JSACS) has implemented various measures. It aims to enhance the access and accountability of the services by working closely with NGOs, women self-help groups, other government departments, corporate/private sector, positive people's networks, and communities. (Jharkhand State AIDS control Society. n.d)
- e. **Awareness Programmes for Non-Communicable Diseases:** There are various awareness programmes for NCDs in India that are implemented by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, in collaboration with various stakeholders, such as state governments, international agencies, civil society organizations, and the private sector. There are several state specific programmes as well focusing on spreading awareness about diabetes, hepatitis etc. For example, Chhattisgarh has launched an initiative to drive awareness about sickle cell disease. The programme focuses on creating public awareness for this genetic disorder, and providing training to health care personnel of the state for diagnosis and treatment of the disease. (Sickle Cell Institute Chhattisgarh Raipur. n.d). A new program named 'Amrutham Aarogyam' has been launched by the Kerala Health Services Department, which has reached out to the people and detected over 10 lakhs cases of diabetes and hypertension. The program also offers free medicines and treatment as per the protocol. (Non-Communicable Disease Prevention And Control Health & Family Welfare Department Govt. Of Kerala, 2020)

3. Table of Insights: Policy Initiatives for Disease Programme

Note 1: Documents linked in the tables include original Acts, Policies, Schemes, Programmes and Guidelines. It is aimed at highlighting and enabling a comparison of relevant policy features covered in the documents, across the centre and the states. While all important documents have been identified, the coverage may not be exhaustive. Further, the 'Policy-at-a-Glance' is not aimed at analysing nuances of policies.

Note 2: Page numbers specified in the Table of Insights are as per the PDF pagination opened in a Google Chrome browser. It is possible to encounter differences in the actual page number for some of the documents when opened in a different web browser/application.

Note 3: Table of insights is bifurcated into communicable and non-communicable programmes.

Communicable Disease Programme:

Geography	Data Points			Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Disease Surveillance	Awareness
	Number of ART Centers (National AIDS Control Organisation)	Adult HIV Prevalence Rate (15-49 years) in 2021 (India HIV Estimates, NACO)	TB Treatment Success Rate in 2021, (India TB Report, MoHFW, 2023), (pg. 246)	Reference Document	State-Specific Action Plan for Containment of AMR	Integrated Disease Surveillance Project	Awareness Programmes for Communicable Diseases
Center	528	0.21%	85.50%	National Action Plan on Antimicrobial Resistance	✓		
				National AIDS Control Organisation Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme		✓	✓
				Andhra Pradesh AIDS Control Society			✓
Andhra Pradesh	40	0.67%	93.10%	Arunachal Pradesh AIDS Control Society			✓
Arunachal Pradesh	1	0.07%	79.30%	Assam AIDS Control Society			✓
Assam	6	0.09%	88.10%				✓

Geography	Data Points			Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Disease Surveillance	Awareness
	Number of ART Centers (National AIDS Control Organisation)	Adult HIV Prevalence Rate (15-49 years) in 2021 (India HIV Estimates, NACO)	TB Treatment Success Rate in 2021, (India TB Report, MoHFW, 2023), (pg. 246)	Reference Document	State-Specific Action Plan for Containment of AMR	Integrated Disease Surveillance Project	Awareness Programmes for Communicable Diseases
Chandigarh	1	0.19%	84.10%	National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme Chandigarh			✓
Delhi	11	0.31%	74.10%	SAPCAR, MoHFW	✓		
				Delhi Planning			✓ (Pg. 19)
				Delhi AIDS Control Society			✓

Geography	Data Point			Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Disease Surveillance	Awareness
	Number of ART Centers (National AIDS Control Organisation)	Adult HIV Prevalence Rate (15-49 years) in 2021 (India HIV Estimates, NACO)	TB Treatment Success Rate in 2021, (India TB Report, MoHFW, 2023), (pg. 246)	Reference Document	State-Specific Action Plan for Containment of AMR	Integrated Disease Surveillance Project	Awareness Programmes for Communicable Diseases
Gujarat	30	0.19%	0.22%	Gujarat AIDS Control Society			✓
Haryana	1	0.22%	83.50%	National Viral Hepatitis Control Programme			✓
				Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Division		✓	
Himachal Pradesh	6	0.11%	87.60%	Himachal Pradesh AIDS Control Society			✓
				Mukhya Mantri Kshay Rog Nivaran Yojna			✓
Jammu & Kashmir	2	0.06%	86.10%	J&K AIDS Control Society			✓

Geography	Data Point			Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Disease Surveillance	Awareness
	Number of ART Centers (National AIDS Control Organisation)	Adult HIV Prevalence Rate (15-49 years) in 2021 (India HIV Estimates, NACO)	TB Treatment Success Rate in 2021, (India TB Report, MoHFW, 2023), (pg. 246	Reference Document	State-Specific Action Plan for Containment of AMR	Integrated Disease Surveillance Project	Awareness Programmes for Communicable Diseases
Karnataka	63	0.46%	82.50%	Karnataka AIDS Control Society			✓ (pg. 4)
Kerala	10	0.06%	79.50%	SAPCAR, MoHFW	✓		
				Non-Communicable Disease Prevention And Control Health & Family Welfare Department Govt. Of Kerala			
				Kerala AIDS Control Society			✓
Ladakh	NA	0.06%	82.20%	Administration of Union Territory of Ladakh			
Lakshadweep	NA	NA	90.00%	Lakshadweep AIDS Control Society			✓
Madhya Pradesh	18	0.08%	84.70%	State Strategic Plan for TB elimination			✓ (Pg. 78)
				SAPCAR, MoHFW	✓		

Geography	Data Point			Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Disease Surveillance	Awareness
	Number of ART Centers (National AIDS Control Organisation)	Adult HIV Prevalence Rate (15-49 years) in 2021 (India HIV Estimates, NACO)	TB Treatment Success Rate in 2021, (India TB Report, MoHFW, 2023), (pg. 246)	Reference Document	State-Specific Action Plan for Containment of AMR	Integrated Disease Surveillance Project	Awareness Programmes for Communicable Diseases
Maharashtra	87	0.33%	86.80%	Maharashtra AIDS Control Society			✓
Meghalaya	1	0.42%	79.40%	Meghalaya AIDS Control Society			✓
Mizoram	6	2.70%	84.80%	Mizoram AIDS Control Society			✓
Odisha	15	0.14%	89.70%	Odisha AIDS Control Society			✓
Puducherry	1	0.31%	80.6%	Animal Disease Surveillance		✓	
Punjab	11	0.28%	84.40%	Punjab AIDS Control Society			✓
Rajasthan	23	0.1%	85.20%	Rajasthan AIDS Control Society			✓

Geography	Data Point		Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Disease Surveillance	Awareness
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	Number of ART Centers (National AIDS Control Organisation)	Adult HIV Prevalence Rate (15-49 years) in 2021 (India HIV Estimates, NACO)	TB Treatment Success Rate in 2021, (India TB Report, MoHFW, 2023), (pg. 246)	Reference Document	State-Specific Action Plan for Containment of AMR	Integrated Disease Surveillance Project	Awareness Programmes for Communicable Diseases
Tamil Nadu	55	0.22%	83.10%	Tamil Nadu AIDS Control Society			✓
Tripura	3	0.12%	85.30%	Tripura AIDS Control Society			✓
Uttar Pradesh	38	0.10%	86.30%	Uttar Pradesh AIDS Control Society			✓
Uttarakhand	3	0.12%	86.70%	Uttarakhand AIDS Control Society			✓
West Bengal	19	0.08%	83.40%	West Bengal AIDS Control Society			✓

Geography	Data Point	Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Awareness
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	Estimated Incidence of Cancer cases in 2022, (Open Government Data Platform India)	Reference Document	Financial Aid for Cancer	Awareness Programmes for Non-Communicable Diseases
Andhra Pradesh	73,536	Government of Andra Pradesh	✓	
Assam	39,787	NHM Assam		✓
		Assam Arogya Nidhi, Government of Assam	✓	
Bihar	1,09,274	NHM Bihar		✓ (Pg. 25)
		Mukhyamantri Chikitsya Sahayati Kosh, Government of Bihar	✓	
Chandigarh	1,088	National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme Chandigarh		✓
Chhattisgarh	29,253	Sickel Cell Disease Raipur		✓
Delhi	26,735	Delhi Planning		✓ (Pg. 18)
		Delhi Arogya Kosh, Government of NCT of Delhi	✓	

Non-Communicable Disease Programme:

Geography	Data Point	Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Awareness
	Estimated Incidence of Cancer cases in 2022, (Open Government Data Platform India)	Reference Document	Financial Aid for Cancer	Awareness Programmes for Non-Communicable Diseases
Goa	1,700	Goa Mediclaim Scheme, Government of Goa	✓	
Gujarat	73,382	Mukhyamantri Amrutum, Government of Gujarat	✓	
Himachal Pradesh	9,164	Mukhya Mantri Sahayat Yojana, Government of Himachal Pradesh	✓	
Kerala	59,143	Non-Communicable Disease Prevention And Control Health & Family Welfare Department Govt. Of Kerala		✓ (Pg. 14)
		Karunya Benevolent Fund, State Health Agency Kerala	✓	

Geography	Data Point	Policy	Prevention and Treatment	Awareness
	Estimated Incidence of Cancer cases in 2022, (Open Government Data Platform India)	Reference Document	Financial Aid for Cancer	Awareness Programmes for Non-Communicable Diseases
Ladakh	302	Administration of Union Territory of Ladakh		✓
Punjab	40,435	MukhMantri Punjab Cancer Rahat Kosh, DoHFW, Government of Punjab	✓	
Rajasthan	74,725	Government of Rajasthan	✓	
Telangana	49,983	Aarogyasri, Government of Telangana	✓	

4.

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